ABC DIGITAL SERVICES

Microsoft 365 Outlook OST Corruption, Shared Mailbox, and Teams Sync

Approved IT Knowledge Article Pack

Document ID	Version	Status	Effective date
ADS-KB-M365-004	1.0	Approved for capstone use	06 Nov 2026

Knowledge owner	Review cycle	Classification	Issue category
Digital Workplace Engineering	Every 6 months	Internal	Collaboration & M365

Fictional organization and sample operating procedures

How to use this article

This document is authoritative only for the fictional ABC Digital Services (ADS) capstone environment. The assistant may explain and recommend these steps, but must not execute privileged actions, approve expenditure, change access, or close a case on the user's behalf.

Retrieval metadata	Value
Document ID	ADS-KB-M365-004
Category	Collaboration & M365
Products / assets	Outlook Desktop, OST cache, Shared Mailbox, Microsoft Teams, OneDrive KFM
Platform	Windows 11, Microsoft 365 Apps for Enterprise
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Effective date	06 Nov 2026
Superseded by	None

Safety boundary: Never request passwords, MFA codes, recovery keys, private keys, or full payment-card data. Stop and escalate if there is smoke, swelling, electric shock, suspected compromise, or possible data loss.

1. Rebuild corrupted Outlook OST cache file

Field	Guidance
Common user phrases	"Outlook stuck updating inbox", "cannot open OST file", "emails missing in desktop app"
Default priority	P3 Normal
Objective	Rebuild local Exchange Offline Storage Table (.ost) without losing unsynced drafts.
Minimum intake	Asset tag; Outlook build version; current OST file size (`%localappdata%\Microsoft\Outlook`); Webmail status.

Procedure

1. Confirm emails are visible and up to date in Outlook on the Web (`outlook.office.com`).

2. Check if any unsent messages exist in the local Outbox and save drafts to Webmail.

3. Close Outlook completely and verify `OUTLOOK.EXE` is not running in Task Manager.

4. Navigate to `%localappdata%\Microsoft\Outlook` and rename the affected `.ost` file to `.ost.bak`.

5. Relaunch Outlook to trigger an automatic clean OST rebuild and set cached Exchange slider to 12 months.

Resolution and escalation

Outcome	Criteria
Resolve when	New OST builds cleanly, folders synchronize, and `.ost.bak` is scheduled for cleanup.

Outcome	Criteria
Escalate when	Issue persists in Outlook Web (Exchange Online mailbox corruption or litigation hold quota full).
Evidence to record	Old OST size, Webmail check status, post-rebuild sync status.
Forbidden actions	Deleting `.pst` local archive files without backup; disabling Exchange Online encryption.

General ticket handling rules

Priority	Use when
P1 Critical	Widespread outage, active security threat, severe safety risk, or executive-critical service unavailable. Page the major-incident or security team immediately.
P2 High	User cannot perform time-critical work and no practical workaround exists. Target assignment within 30 minutes.
P3 Normal	Single-user degradation or standard fulfillment request. Target assignment within 4 business hours.
P4 Low	Information request, planned change, or non-urgent accessory request. Target assignment within 1 business day.

Standard ticket record

Record requestor, business justification, device or application, asset tag where applicable, location, symptoms, error text, start time, impact, troubleshooting attempted, approvals, evidence, result, and next owner. Do not paste secrets or unnecessary personal data.

Knowledge quality and review

The knowledge owner reviews this article every six months and after any major process, product, security, or supplier change. Superseded versions must be excluded from retrieval. Conflicts are resolved in favor of the newest approved article; otherwise the assistant must disclose the conflict and recommend escalation.

Reference basis

• Secure AI Troubleshooting Assistant BRD v1.0: approved content, metadata, ordered guidance, citations, verification, safe fallback, and escalation.

• NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3 (2025): Detect, Respond, Recover, and continuous improvement concepts for security-related incidents.

• Microsoft Intune and Windows Autopilot documentation: managed application deployment, device enrollment, assignment, and lifecycle practices.

• ITIL-aligned service management practices: incident, request, change, asset, and knowledge management concepts.